

NSS Rounds

The National Sample Surveys (NSS) are being conducted by the Government of India since 1950 to collect socio-economic data employing scientific sampling methods. The first round of NSS was conducted during October 1950 to March 1951 to collect data on land utilization, prices of selected items, wage rates, and consumer expenditure.

NSS Round/Survey Period	Objective
79th/(July 2022 - June 2023)	- Comprehensive Annual Modular Survey (CAMS) [This will accommodate various requirements of different ministries/dept.] - Survey on living conditions and other related aspects of Tribals in India. - Survey on AYUSH.
78th/(Jan '20 - Dec '20) [extended till 15 Aug 2021]	- Domestic Tourism Expenditure - Multiple Indicator Survey
77th/(Jan '19 - Dec '19) (Reference Period: July'18-June'19 i.e. Agricultural Year)	- Land & Livestock Holdings of Households and Situation Assessment of Agricultural Households. - Debt and Investment Survey (AIDIS) - Time Use Survey [for the first time]

76th/(July '18 - Dec '18)	Drinking Water, Sanitation, Hygiene, and Housing condition in India (Also Person with Disabilities in India was conducted)
75th/(July '17 - June '18)	- Household Social Consumption: Education and Health - Consumer Expenditure Survey
74th/(July '16 - June '17)	Survey on Service Sector Enterprises
1st/(Oct 1950 to Mar 1951)	Small-scale manufacture and handicrafts (household)

- Broad subjects covered by NSS Rounds:

- | | |
|--|--|
| i.) Household Consumption Expenditure | ii.) Employment-Unemployment and Migration |
| iii.) Household Wealth and Finance | iv.) Health and Hygiene |
| v.) Education | vi.) Literacy |
| vii.) Non-agricultural Enterprises | |
| viii.) Land & Livestock holdings and other agrarian issues | |
| ix.) Other subjects (as per needs) | |

- In NSS Surveys, at present, a standard sampling design is used- two or three-stage stratified random sampling using a circular systematic method of selection with probability proportional to size.**
- The NSS is a multi-purpose socio-economic inquiry of all-India coverage, carried out in the form of successive "rounds", the duration of a round being typically one year (July-June).

NSS 79th Round:

1. Objective of the Survey: **(CAMS)** schedule (CAMS, 2021) is designed to collect information required to generate some important socio-economic indicators, demands for which have increased significantly during the past few years. The importance of having globally comparable indices measuring and monitoring the performance of the country in various socio-economic dimensions has also been emphasized in different forum.
2. **Survey on AYUSH** of NSS 79th round is going to be the first survey of its kind. The main objective of this survey is to get an idea about the awareness and penetration of AYUSH systems of medicine in Indian population. An attempt was made in the survey of Household Consumer Expenditure, NSS 68th round, 2011-12 to get some estimates on awareness and uses of AYUSH system of medicine by the household.

NSS 77th Round:

1. Objective of the Survey- The integrated **Survey on Land and Livestock holdings of Households and Situation Assessment of Agricultural Households**, conducted in the rural areas of the country, had an objective of generating different indicators like: -ownership and operational holdings of rural households; -ownership of livestock; -income, productive assets and indebtedness of agricultural households; -farming practices of agricultural households; -awareness and access to various technological developments in the field of agriculture; -receipts and expenditure of the 'agricultural households' farm and non-farm businesses and receipts from all other economic activities pursued by the members of the agricultural households.

Collection of information- The information was collected in two visits from the same set of sample households in rural areas with a view to collect relevant information separately for the two halves of the agricultural year July 2018 – June 2019. The first visit was made during January -August 2019 and the second was during September- December 2019.

Agricultural household- An agricultural household for NSS 77th Round survey was defined as a household receiving more than Rs. 4000/- as value of produce from agricultural activities (e.g., cultivation of field crops, horticultural crops, fodder crops, plantation, animal husbandry, poultry, fishery, piggery, bee-keeping, vermiculture, sericulture, etc.) and having at least one member self-employed in agriculture either in the principal status or in subsidiary status during last 365 days.

Household Ownership Holdings of Land- Land, with permanent heritable possession, with or without right to transfer the title, was considered as owned land. The land held in owner-like possession under a long-term lease or assignment (e.g., village land possessed by a tribal household as per traditional tribal rights or community land customarily operated by a tenant for a long period) was also treated as land owned.

Household Operational Holdings- Household operational holding has been defined as land that was used wholly or partly for agricultural production and was operated (directed/managed) by one household member alone or with assistance of others, without regard to title, size or location. Within a household, multiple operational holdings were not distinguished. The land might be operated by members belonging to a single household or by members belonging to more than one household operating jointly. However, holdings operated as cooperative farms were not considered as household operational holding in this survey. A household growing vegetable in the kitchen garden or flowers in the courtyard or raising livestock & poultry or carrying out pisciculture was considered to operate a holding, even if no crop production was undertaken by it during the reference period.

Area of operational holding: Operational holding encompasses all land - owned, leased in or otherwise possessed with the condition that some agricultural activity was carried out on any part of the land under its possession during the reference period.

Area operated: Only the area used for agricultural activities in the operational holding in a reference period is termed as area operated.

2. objective of the **Survey on Debt & Investment**- to collect basic quantitative information on the assets and liabilities of the households as on 30.6.2018. Besides, the survey gathered information on the amount of capital expenditure incurred by the households during the Agricultural Year 2018-19 (July-June), under different heads, like residential buildings, farm business and non-farm business.

-survey was spread over the entire Indian Union and data were collected in two visits (Visit 1: January-August, 2019 and Visit 2: September - December, 2019) from the same set of sample households.

-following indicators were generated from the survey of All India Debt & Investment:

#Average value of Assets (AVA): The average value of all the physical and financial assets owned per household as on 30.06.2018.

#Incidence of Indebtedness (IOI): The percentage of the indebted households as on 30.06.2018.

#Average amount of Debt (AOD): The average amount of cash dues as on 30.06.2018 per household.

#Average Fixed Capital Expenditure by the households during 01.07.2018 to 30.06.2019

3. **Time Use Survey:** - conducted for the first time

-Objective of the survey: to measure participation of men and women in paid and unpaid activities. TUS is an important source of information on the time spent in unpaid caregiving activities, volunteer work, unpaid domestic service producing activities of the household members. It also provides information on time spent on learning, socializing, leisure activities, self-care activities, etc., by the household members.

-Data on time use was collected through Personal Interview method. Information on time use was collected covering a period of 24 hrs. starting from 4AM on day before the date of interview to 4AM on the day of interview.

-Results presented on time use are for persons of age 6 years and above.

-key indicators of time use survey are calculated as follows:

i.)Participation rate in a day in any activity is calculated as the percentage of persons performing that activity during the day

ii.)Average time spent in a day per participant for any activity is calculated by considering those who participated in the activity. Estimates of average time in a day in different activities derived by considering only the participants in the activities are referred to as average time spent in a day per participant.

iii.)Average time spent in a day per person for any activity is calculated by considering all the persons irrespective of whether they participated in the activity or not. By this approach, distribution of total time of 1440 minutes of a day per person in different activities is derived.

-(TUS) provides a framework for measuring time dispositions by the population on different activities. It is an important source of information about the activities that are performed by the population and the time duration for which such activities are performed. One distinguishing feature of Time Use Survey from other household surveys is that it can capture time disposition on different aspects of human activities, be it paid, unpaid or other activities with such details which is not possible in other surveys.

NSS 76th Round:

1. objective of the survey- to collect information on facilities of drinking water, sanitation along with housing facilities available to the households and the micro environment surrounding the houses which are important determinants of overall quality of living condition of the people.
-The important aspects on which the information was collected in the survey are: type of the dwelling unit (viz. independent house, flat etc.), tenurial status of the dwelling unit (viz. owned, hired, no dwelling etc.), structure of the dwelling unit (viz. pucca, semi-pucca, katcha), condition of the structure (viz. good, satisfactory, bad), floor area of the dwelling unit, age of the house owned by the household, facilities available to the households in respect of drinking water, bathroom, latrine etc. and micro environment surrounding the house like drainage system of the house, system of disposal of household waste water, system of disposal of household garbage, problems of flies and mosquitoes etc.
2. objective of the Survey of Persons with Disabilities: to estimate indicators of incidence and prevalence of disability, cause of disability, age at onset of disability, facilities available to the persons with disability, difficulties faced by persons with disability in accessing/using public building/public transport, arrangement of regular care giver, out-of pocket expenses relating to disability, etc

NSS 75th Round:

1. Household Social Consumption: Education
-objective: to build indicators on participation of the persons of age 3 to 35 years in the education system, expenditure incurred on education of the household members and various indicators of those currently not attending education (i.e., for the persons who never enrolled or ever enrolled but currently not attending education). For persons of age 5 years and above, information was also collected on ability to operate computer, ability to use internet and use of internet during last 30 days. In addition to these, information on current attendance and related expenditure in respect of the

erstwhile members of age 3 to 35 years currently attending education of the households were also collected.

2. Household Social Consumption: Health

-objective: to gather basic quantitative information on the health sector viz. morbidity, profile of ailments including their treatment, role of government and private facilities in providing healthcare, expenditure on medicines, expenditure on medical consultation and investigation, hospitalisation and expenditure thereon, maternity and childbirth, the condition of the aged, etc.

FAQs

- ☐ The socio-economic surveys are conducted in the form of rounds, each round being normally of one-year duration, generally from July to June synchronizing with the agriculture year in the Indian context. The entire period of one year is divided into 4 sub-rounds with 3 months' duration each. This helps in building up progressive estimates of aggregates as also taking care of seasonality, if any, available in the character(s) under study. There were occasions when a round was conducted for a period of six months also.
- ☐ The general sampling design is a stratified multi-stage design for NSS surveys. The First Stage Units (FSUs) are villages/UFS blocks/ Sub-Units (SUs) as per the situation. The Ultimate Stage Units (USUs) are households/enterprises in both rural and urban sectors.
- ☐ **Stratification:** Within each district of a State/UT, two basic strata are formed: i) rural stratum comprising all rural areas of the district, and (ii) urban stratum comprising all urban areas of the district. However, within the urban areas of a district, if there are one or more towns with population one million or more, each of them will form a separate basic stratum and the remaining urban areas of the district will be considered as another basic stratum. A special stratum, in the rural areas only, will be formed at all-India level before district level strata are formed in each State/UT. This stratum will comprise all the uninhabited villages belonging to all States/UTs.

- ☐ Do NSS surveys follow any reference period for the collection of data?

Reference period refers to the period to which the data collected relates to. Reference period should not be too long; otherwise the data collected will not be of requisite quality due to the recall lapse of the informant. On the other hand, if the reference period is too short, it may miss some of the relevant items/ situations from coverage. The duration of the reference period will depend upon the items on which information is to be collected. In NSO inquiries, we take a moving reference period of 365 days for collecting information on income; usual status of persons in Labour Force Surveys; consumption expenditure on durable items, clothing and foot-wear in case of consumer expenditure survey; inputs and outputs in enterprise surveys. A moving reference period of 30 days is usually adopted for recording the data on consumer expenditure. For deciding the current status of persons in employment and unemployment survey, a period of 7 days prior to the date of survey is taken as a reference period and the labour time disposition of the persons for all the 7 days is recorded. Adoption of a moving reference period ensures coverage of entire period and eliminates the seasonality effect when aggregated over entire period.

- ☐ Round of CES collected the survey data on consumer expenditure for three different reference periods:

Uniform Reference period (URP): Data on expenditure incurred are collected from the household for each item during last 30 days.

Mixed Reference Period (MRP): Data on expenditure incurred are collected for the items other than clothing, bedding, footwear, medical (institutional), education, durable goods during last 30 days and for these items during last 365 days.

Modified Mixed Reference Period (MMRP): Data on expenditure incurred are collected for the items falling under edible oil, egg, fish & meat; vegetables, fruits, spices, beverages and processed foods, pan, tobacco & intoxicants during last seven days; clothing, bedding, footwear, education, medical (institutional), durable goods during last 365 days; all other food, fuel and light, miscellaneous goods and services including non-institutional medical; rents and taxes during last 30 days.

-Estimates based on MMRP survey data are considered to be more robust because of shorter reference periods for most of the food items, to take care of memory lapse on expenditure incurred daily or at very high frequency on these items, and larger reference periods for items of infrequent consumption. It is, therefore, internationally practiced to compile weights of CPI using MMRP data.

☐ **Uses of NSS socio-economic data?**

The NSS inquiries on consumer expenditure are the main source of data on level of living of the Indian population. The data thrown up by these inquiries form the basis of all poverty calculations carried out by the Planning Commission, which include setting up of the poverty line and estimation of the number and proportion of the poor in different States/U.Ts of the country. The NSS data on employment and unemployment are used in labour force projection and manpower planning. NSS data have been extensively used in the national income estimation by the CSO. Data on household expenditure on education have been used in working out private expenditure on education. The literacy rates based on the surveys of the NSO have been taken as official estimates of literacy rates during the inter census period. Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment uses the information relating to disabled persons collected by the NSO for formulation of policies and programmes. Other Central and State Government Departments, Reserve Bank of India etc. are also using data collected by the NSO.

The survey on land & livestock holdings generates basic quantitative information on agrarian structure of the country, in terms of ownership as well as operation of land holdings. In addition, the survey provides information on livestock holdings by size-class of operational land holdings. Through surveys on debt and investment, the NSO has been meeting the information needs of the Reserve Bank of India in respect of debt and investment of rural and urban households. The data collected through these surveys are used for obtaining reliable estimates of Debt, Borrowing and Capital formation. These estimates are used for formulating banking policies. The survey on 'Morbidity and Health Care', which is conducted on a decennial basis, generates information relating to morbidity, problems of aged persons, utilization of health care services provided by public and private sectors and expenditure on medical treatment.